First steps

Getting Started

Install OpenClaw, run onboarding, and chat with your AI assistant — all in about 5 minutes. By the end you will have a running Gateway, configured auth, and a working chat session.

What you need

- **Node.js** — Node 24 recommended (Node 22.14+ also supported)
- **An API key** from a model provider (Anthropic, OpenAI, Google, etc.) — onboarding will prompt you

> Check your Node version with `node --version`. **Windows users:** both native Windows and WSL2 are supported. WSL2 is more stable and recommended for the full experience. See **Windows**. Need to install Node? See **Node setup**.

Quick setup

1 **Install OpenClaw**

macOS / Linux Windows (PowerShell)

```
curl -fsSL https://openclaw.ai/install.sh | bash
```

```
seb@ubuntu:~$ curl -fsSL https://openclaw.ai/install.sh | bash
```

> Other install methods (Docker, Nix, npm): **Install**.

2 **Run onboarding**

```
openclaw onboard --install-daemon
```

The wizard walks you through choosing a model provider, setting an API key, and configuring the Gateway. It takes about 2 minutes.

See **Onboarding (CLI)** for the full reference.

3 **Verify the Gateway is running**

```
openclaw gateway status
```

You should see the Gateway listening on port 18789.

4 **Open the dashboard**

```
openclaw dashboard
```

This opens the Control UI in your browser. If it loads, everything is working.

5 **Send your first message**

Type a message in the Control UI chat and you should get an AI reply.

Want to chat from your phone instead? The fastest channel to set up is **Telegram** (just a bot token). See **Channels** for all options.

What to do next

Connect a channel
WhatsApp, Telegram, Discord, iMessage, and more.

Pairing and safety
Control who can message your agent.

Configure the Gateway
Models, tools, sandbox, and advanced settings.

Browse tools
Browser, exec, web search, skills, and plugins.

Advanced: environment variables

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